EXPERIMENT 11

Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production Environment

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Aim

To demonstrate the development-to-production deployment workflow of a Zoho Creator application using the Environments feature, and to manage a multi-stage pipeline of isolated sandboxes (Development, Stage and Production) so that changes are built, tested and released in a controlled manner.

Introduction to Multi-Stage Deployment

Zoho Creator provides an Environments feature, described on its page as a multi-stage deployment space to test and publish an application without affecting the production. Each environment is a separate, isolated copy of the application hosted in the cloud, with its own version of the forms, reports, workflows and data. A change made in one environment does not reach the next until it is deliberately deployed. An application passes through three environments:

Environment	Purpose
Development	The sandbox in which the application is built, configured and changed. Changes made here do not reach end users.
Stage	An intermediate testing environment, a replica of the release candidate, in which the application is deployed, tested and approved before release.
Production	The live environment in which the tested application is published and used by end users.



Figure 11.0: Multi-Stage Deployment Pipeline (Conceptual Diagram)

Why isolated workspaces matter

Because the three environments are isolated, unfinished or unverified work can never disturb the live application. Structural changes such as new fields, altered validation, rewritten workflows or changed permissions are first made in Development, where a failure affects only the developer. The change is then promoted to Stage, where it is tested against realistic conditions without touching real campus data. Only after it is approved is it published to Production. This protects the live sustainability tracker from system downtime, broken forms, lost or corrupted energy, water and waste records and unverified structural changes, and keeps every release controlled, traceable and reversible through Version History.

Application Used

Smart Campus Sustainability & Carbon Tracker – an application to monitor campus electricity, water and waste, estimate carbon emissions, record green activities and student participation, and manage sustainability complaints.

Procedure

The deployment follows the flow: Development Environment → Stage Environment → Production Environment.

Note: Figures 11.1 to 11.4 are illustrative views created to demonstrate the stages of the deployment workflow; they are not captures of a completed deployment. The sample statuses and dates in them are for illustration only.

1. Sign in to Zoho Creator. The home page shows the Smart Campus Sustainability & Carbon Tracker application. The left panel is divided into the groups DEVELOP, DEPLOY and MANAGE; the DEPLOY group contains the Environments, Mobile and Portal options. The Environments option (highlighted in red) is used for deploying applications across environments.

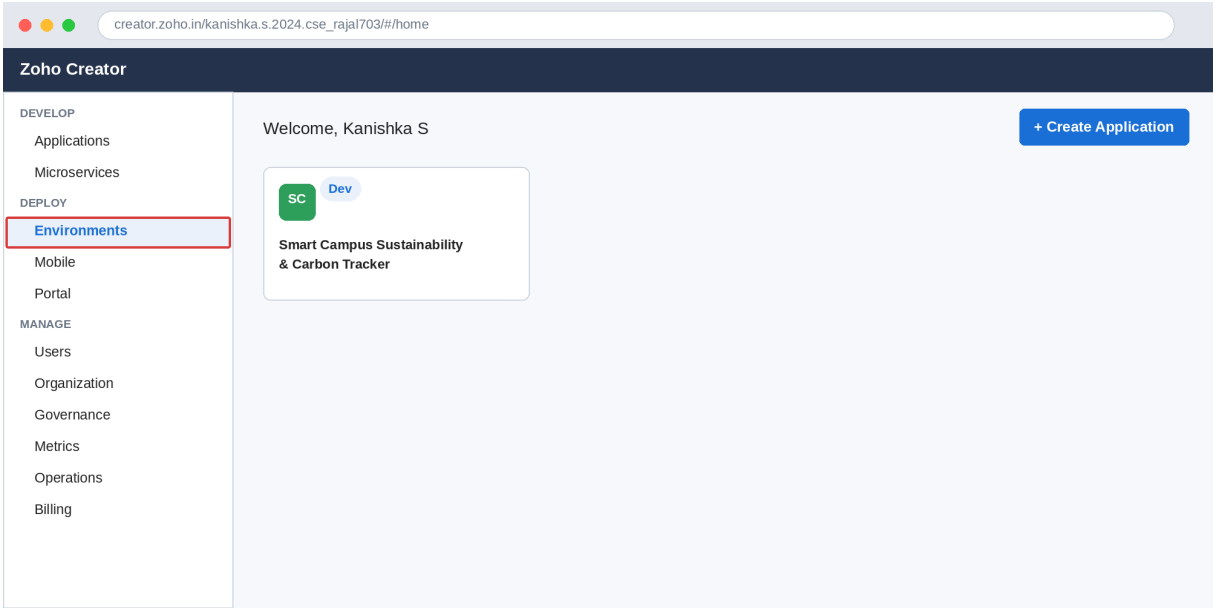


Figure 11.1: Zoho Creator Home – Smart Campus Application and the DEPLOY → Environments Option (Illustrative)

2. Select **Environments** under DEPLOY. The Environments page opens with the description “Multi-stage deployment space to test and publish your application without affecting the production”, and with the Version History, Manage and Publish options at the top. The Stage and Production environments are shown as separate columns. The application added to the environment is listed in the left panel with the status “Changes available”, and the Stage and Production columns show “Not yet published”.

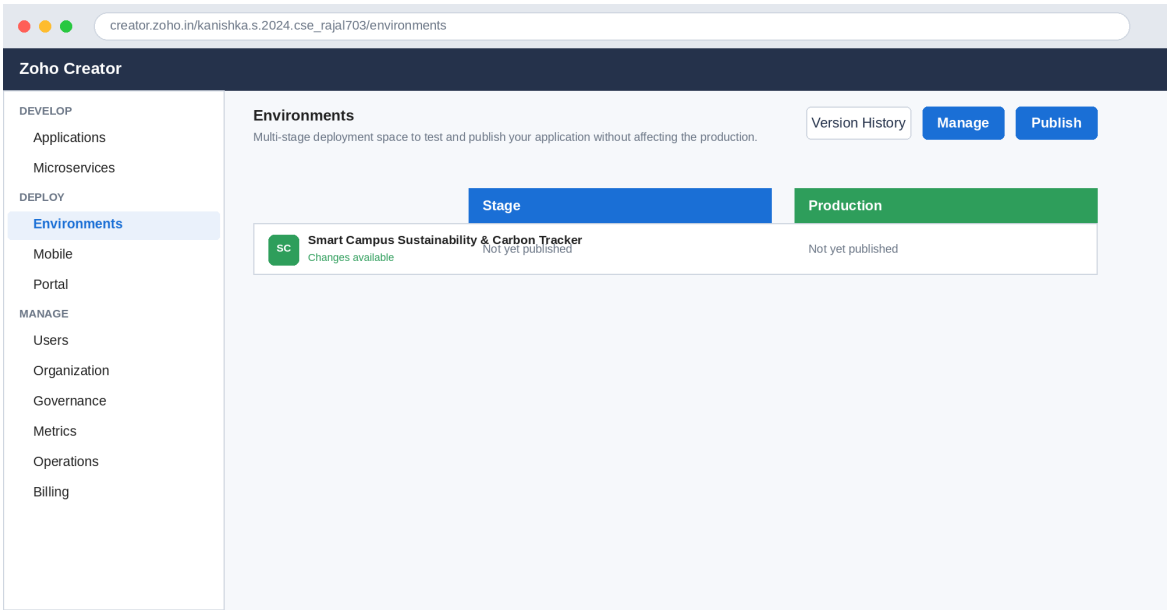


Figure 11.2: Environments Page – Smart Campus Application Listed with Stage and Production Not Yet Published (Illustrative)

3. If the application is not listed, select Add Application and add the Smart Campus Sustainability & Carbon Tracker application to the environment. Once the application is published, version 1.0 is listed under the Stage and Production columns and the status of the application changes to "No changes available". The Version History, Manage and Publish options are used to manage releases (Figure 11.3).

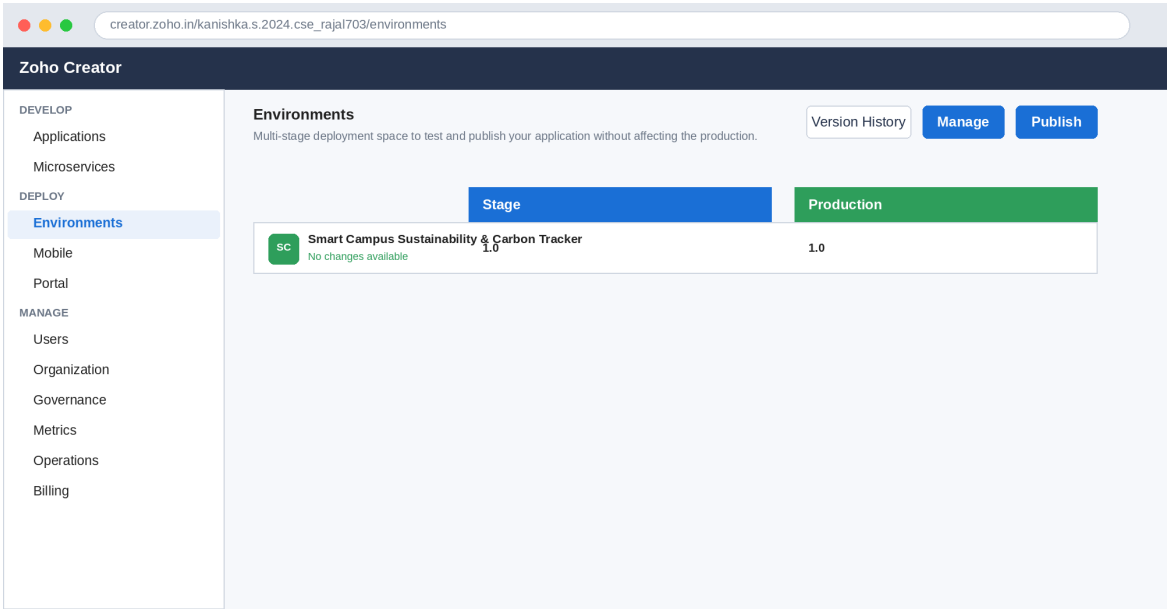


Figure 11.3: Environments Page – Application with Version 1.0 in Stage and Production (Illustrative)

4. **Development environment:** the application is built and configured here. Its status is shown as Deployed with the description "Application configured and ready for deployment".

5. **Stage environment:** the application is deployed to Stage, tested and approved. Its status is Deployed with the description "Application tested and approved in Stage".

6. **Production environment:** after approval in Stage, the application is published to Production. The Production tab is selected, the Environment is Production and the status is Live, with the message "The application is published and live in Production." The Deployment Progress panel shows Production as Live – "Application is live and accessible to end users" (Figure 11.4).

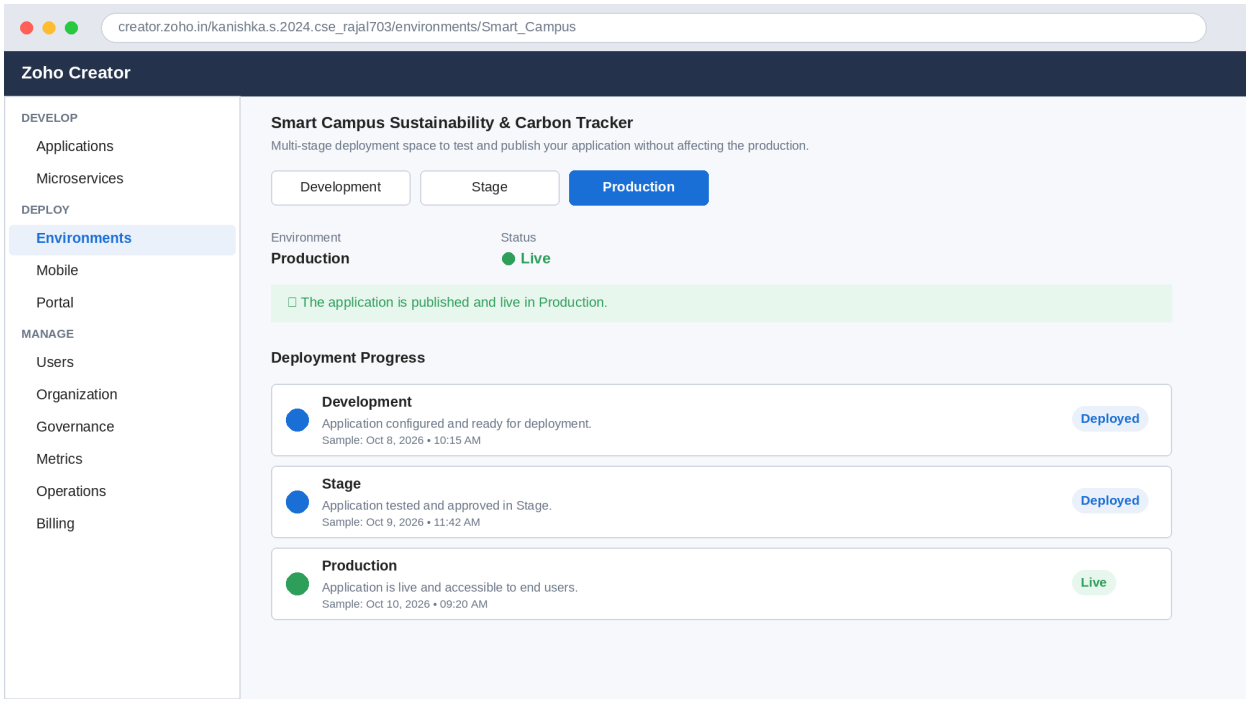


Figure 11.4: Deployment Progress – Smart Campus Application Live in Production (Illustrative)

Infrastructure Timeline

The progression of the application from inception to production rollout, as displayed in the Deployment Progress panel of the illustration, is summarised below. The dates and times are sample values used for illustration.

Stage	Environment	Status	Description Shown	Date and Time (Sample)
1	Development	Deployed	Application configured and ready for deployment.	Oct 8, 2026 • 10:15 AM
2	Stage	Deployed	Application tested and approved in Stage.	Oct 9, 2026 • 11:42 AM
3	Production	Live	Application is live and accessible to end users.	Oct 10, 2026 • 09:20 AM

Result

The following were carried out for the Smart Campus Sustainability & Carbon Tracker application:

- The Environments page under DEPLOY was accessed and the Stage and Production environments were studied.
- The application was seen listed in the environment with the status “Changes available” and “Not yet published” in Stage and Production.
- The development-to-production flow (Development → Stage → Production) was demonstrated through illustrative views, including version 1.0 in Stage and Production and the Deployment Progress panel with Production shown as Live.

Conclusion

The experiment explained how a Zoho Creator application moves from development to production through environments. The Smart Campus Sustainability & Carbon Tracker is configured in Development, deployed to Stage where it is tested and approved, and then published to Production, where it becomes live and accessible to end users. This staged approach satisfies the testing framework expected of an enterprise release: isolation of work in progress, verification before release, a controlled and traceable promotion path, and Version History for review. It keeps the live sustainability tracker protected from untested changes and downtime, and makes releases controlled and traceable.